

WE ARE WOLF

InDesign Publication Production Guide

*A comprehensive step-by-step manual for importing, designing, and
exporting a flawless print-ready book in Adobe InDesign*

Prepared for Kennedy Singh · Mangu Publishing House

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How to Use This Guide

This guide is designed as a comprehensive, step-by-step manual that a production assistant can follow from start to finish. Each section contains detailed instructions, checklists, and AI prompts to streamline the workflow.

Understanding the Icons

Icon	Meaning	Action
	Action Item	A task that must be completed manually. Check off each box as you finish.
	AI Prompt	Copy-paste this text into InDesign's AI interface or use as guidance for AI-assisted workflows.
	Warning	Critical information that could cause errors if ignored.
	Tip	Helpful suggestion to improve quality or save time.

Recommended Workflow

Follow the sections in order. Do not skip ahead. Each section builds upon the previous one:

1. Complete ALL checklists in Section I (Preparation) before opening InDesign.
2. Set up your InDesign document using Section II as your configuration reference.
3. Import the manuscript (Section III) only after document setup is complete.
4. Place images (Section IV) after text import and cleanup.
5. Refine typography (Section V) after all content is in place.
6. Add front and back matter (Section VI) near the end.
7. Configure color and review print settings (Section VII).
8. Run the final export checklist (Section VIII) before creating print files.
9. Complete the quality assurance checklist (Section IX) as a final verification.

Using the Checklists

Each checklist item begins with an empty checkbox (☐). As you complete each task, mark it as done. These checklists are designed to ensure no step is overlooked.

☐ = Not started ☒ = Completed ☐ = In progress

Using the AI Prompts

AI prompts are provided in highlighted boxes throughout this guide. They are designed to be copied directly into InDesign's AI-powered features or used with compatible AI assistants. Each prompt includes a description of when to use it and the expected result.

While AI can accelerate many tasks, always verify the output manually. AI is a tool to assist production, not a replacement for human judgment in design decisions.

 **Tip:** Start each work session by reviewing which checklist items remain. Save your InDesign file with version numbers (e.g., WeAreWolf_v01.indd) after completing each major section.

Section I: Pre-InDesign Preparation

Before opening Adobe InDesign, complete all preparation tasks. Thorough preparation prevents costly rework and ensures a smooth layout process. This section covers file auditing, manuscript cleanup, image preparation, and typography planning.

1.1 File Audit Checklist

Verify that all manuscript components are present and organized before beginning layout work.

- ☐ Locate the final manuscript file (We_Are_Wolf.docx recommended)
- ☐ Confirm all 12 chapters are present and in correct order
- ☐ Verify Part I, Part II, Part III dividers are marked
- ☐ Confirm front matter is complete (Cover, Title, Copyright, Dedication, TOC)
- ☐ Confirm back matter is complete (Epilogue, Acknowledgments, About Author)
- ☐ Check that all chapter illustrations are in a single organized folder
- ☐ Verify image file formats (JPG/PNG, minimum 300 DPI at print size)
- ☐ Create a backup of the original files before any modification
- ☐ Rename image files with consistent naming (e.g., ch01_electricity.jpg)
- ☐ Open DOCX in Word and run Spell Check → Grammar Check
- ☐ Review for any tracked changes or comments — accept or delete all
- ☐ Confirm no redlines/revisions remain in the document

 **Warning:** Always work on copies of original files. Never modify the only existing version of any manuscript file or image asset.

1.2 Manuscript Cleanup Tasks

Clean formatting ensures InDesign can import the manuscript cleanly without conflicts from Word's inline styling.

- ☐ Remove any manual page breaks that will conflict with InDesign flow
- ☐ Ensure chapter titles use consistent heading styles (Heading 1)
- ☐ Ensure part titles use a distinct style (Heading 2 or custom "Part Title")
- ☐ Apply consistent body text style throughout
- ☐ Mark all illustrations with consistent figure captions
- ☐ Remove any inline images — replace with placeholder text [IMAGE: filename.jpg]
- ☐ Verify italic text is actually italic (not underlined or colored)
- ☐ Check for straight quotes — replace with typographic curly quotes
- ☐ Check for double spaces — replace with single spaces
- ☐ Verify em-dashes (—) not double hyphens (--)

- ☐ Verify en-dashes (–) used for number ranges
- ☐ Check ellipsis (...) not three periods (...)
- ☐ Save as .DOCX with all formatting preserved
- ☐ ALSO save a plain-text version for emergency reference

 **Tip:** Use Word's Find/Replace with wildcards to catch double spaces and straight quotes quickly. Search for ^w^w (two spaces) and replace with ^w (one space).

1.3 Image Asset Preparation

All images must be properly prepared before placement in InDesign. Use the table below to track your image assets.

Chapter	Image Description	Current File	Target DPI	Print Size	Status
Ch 1	Placeholder	ch01_electricity.jpg	300	4.5" x 3"	☐ Pending
Ch 2	Placeholder	ch02_resonance.jpg	300	4.5" x 3"	☐ Pending
Ch 3	Placeholder	ch03_intelligence.jp g	300	4.5" x 3"	☐ Pending
...	...	...	...	...	...

Table 1: Image Asset Tracking Template (fill in as assets are prepared)

- ☐ Create master image folder: "WeAreWolf_Images"
- ☐ Ensure all images are 300 DPI minimum at final print size
- ☐ Convert any RGB images to CMYK color mode
- ☐ Verify image dimensions work within trim size + margins
- ☐ Rename all files consistently (ch01_name.jpg, ch02_name.jpg, etc.)
- ☐ Create low-res FPO (For Position Only) versions if needed
- ☐ Verify no images have embedded color profiles that conflict
- ☐ Create spreadsheet tracking all image assets

1.4 Font & Typography Decisions

The following table recommends a complete type system for the book. These decisions should be made before setting up InDesign paragraph styles.

Element	Recommended Font	Size	Leading	Notes
Body Text	Garamond Premier Pro	11pt	14.5pt	Excellent readability for long-form prose

Element	Recommended Font	Size	Leading	Notes
Chapter Titles	Cormorant Garamond	28pt	34pt	Elegant, literary feel
Part Titles	Cormorant Garamond Light	36pt	42pt	Dramatic break between sections
Running Header	Garamond Premier Pro	8pt	10pt	Italic, book title on verso
Page Numbers	Garamond Premier Pro	9pt	—	Centered footer, recto/verso
Drop Caps	Cormorant Garamond	3 lines	—	First paragraph of each chapter only
Captions	Garamond Premier Pro Italic	9pt	11pt	Centered under images
Dedication	Cormorant Garamond Light	12pt	20pt	Italic, centered, generous leading

Table 2: Recommended Type System for We Are Wolf

Alternative Font Choices

If Garamond Premier Pro is unavailable, acceptable alternatives include:

- Adobe Garamond Pro (very similar, widely available)
- EB Garamond (excellent free alternative via Google Fonts)
- Sabon (slightly more formal, equally readable)
- Minion Pro (more modern feel, excellent at small sizes)

 **Tip:** Always test your chosen fonts with a sample chapter before committing. Print a test page to evaluate readability at actual size.

Section II: InDesign Document Setup

This section guides you through creating the foundational InDesign document structure. Proper setup at this stage prevents rework later and ensures consistency throughout the book.

2.1 New Document Settings

- ☐ Launch Adobe InDesign (latest version recommended)
- ☐ File → New → Document
- ☐ Intent: Print
- ☐ Page Size: Custom (5.5" x 8.5" for literary fiction)
- ☐ Pages: 300 (approximate, add more as needed)
- ☐ Facing Pages: YES (for literary book feel)
- ☐ Start Page # from: 1
- ☐ Columns: 1
- ☐ Margins: Top 0.75", Bottom 0.875", Inside 0.875", Outside 0.75"
- ☐ Bleed: Top 0.125", Bottom 0.125", Inside 0", Outside 0.125"
- ☐ Slug: Optional (for printer notes)
- ☐ Click "Save Preset" → Name: "WeAreWolf_Book_5.5x8.5"

AI Prompts — Document Setup

AI PROMPT

"Create a new InDesign document for a 5.5x8.5 inch literary fiction book with facing pages, 0.75 inch margins, and a warm, earthy color theme for the workspace."

AI PROMPT

"Set up master pages for a book with alternating left/right page layouts, including running headers with book title and chapter name, and centered page numbers in the footer."

AI PROMPT

"Configure paragraph styles for a literary novel including body text, chapter titles, part dividers, first paragraph with drop cap, and block quotes."

2.2 Master Pages Setup

Master pages control the repeating elements of your book layout. Set up the following master pages:

A-Master (Default)

Applied to all body text pages. Contains running headers and page numbers.

- ☐ Create A-Master by duplicating the default master
- ☐ Add running header on verso (left): Book title "WE ARE WOLF" in italic
- ☐ Add running header on recto (right): Current chapter name in italic
- ☐ Add centered page number in footer on both left and right
- ☐ Set header text to Garamond Premier Pro 8pt italic
- ☐ Set page numbers to Garamond Premier Pro 9pt
- ☐ Add thin horizontal rule below header (0.25pt, warm brown)
- ☐ Position header within top margin area
- ☐ Position footer within bottom margin area

B-Master (Chapter Openers)

Applied to the first page of each chapter. No running header, larger chapter number.

- ☐ Create B-Master based on A-Master
- ☐ Remove running header from B-Master
- ☐ Keep page number in footer (centered)
- ☐ Add generous top margin space for chapter number
- ☐ Add decorative rule element below chapter title area
- ☐ Apply B-Master to first page of each chapter automatically via paragraph style

C-Master (Part Dividers)

Applied to part divider pages. Centered part title, minimal elements.

- ☐ Create C-Master for part divider pages
- ☐ Remove running headers and page numbers
- ☐ Center part title vertically on page
- ☐ Add "Part I / II / III" label above part name
- ☐ Use Cormorant Garamond Light 36pt for part title
- ☐ Consider adding subtle decorative element below part title

D-Master (Blank)

For pages that should have no header or footer (copyright, dedication, etc.).

- ☐ Create D-Master with no running headers
- ☐ Create D-Master with no page numbers

- ☐ Apply to half-title page
- ☐ Apply to copyright page
- ☐ Apply to dedication page
- ☐ Apply to intentionally blank pages

2.3 Paragraph Styles Setup

Create all paragraph styles before importing text. This ensures consistent formatting throughout. Define each style in the order below.

Body Text Style

The foundation of the book's typography.

Font Family	Garamond Premier Pro
Size	11pt
Leading	14.5pt
Alignment	Left (ragged right) or Justified
First-line Indent	1.5em
Space After	0pt
Hyphenation	On (min 5 letters, 2 before/after)
Optical Margin	Enabled

Body Text First Style

Used for the first paragraph after a heading. No indent since the heading provides the break.

Chapter Title Style

Font Family	Cormorant Garamond
Size	28pt
Leading	34pt
Alignment	Centered
Space Before	4 inches (from top of page)
Space After	48pt
Page Break	Before (always starts new page)
Master Page	B-Master on first page
Rule Below	0.5pt, warm brown, width 40%

Part Title Style

Font Family	Cormorant Garamond Light
Size	36pt
Leading	42pt
Alignment	Centered
Space Before	Vertically centered on page
Space After	24pt
Master Page	C-Master
Page Break	Before, to recto (right) page

Drop Cap Style

Applied to the first paragraph after each chapter title. Creates a large initial letter spanning three lines.

AI Prompts — Paragraph Styles



AI PROMPT

"Create a paragraph style for literary fiction body text using Garamond font, 11pt size, 14.5pt leading, with a 1.5em first-line indent and no space between paragraphs. Apply optical margin alignment."



AI PROMPT

"Set up a chapter title style with Cormorant Garamond, 28pt, centered, with a page break before, and add a rule below with 0.5pt weight in warm brown color."



AI PROMPT

"Create a drop cap style that applies a 3-line drop cap in Cormorant Garamond to the first letter of the first paragraph after each chapter heading."



AI PROMPT

"Configure automatic chapter openers that suppress the running header on the first page of each chapter and use a different master page layout."

2.4 Character Styles Setup

Character styles apply formatting to selected text within paragraphs. Create these for consistent inline formatting.

Style Name	Font	Size	Attributes	Usage
Italic Emphasis	Garamond Premier Pro Italic	Inherit ed	Italic	Emphasis within body text

Style Name	Font	Size	Attributes	Usage
Bold Emphasis	Garamond Premier Pro Semibold	Inherited	Bold	Strong emphasis, rare in literary
Small Caps	Garamond Premier Pro	Inherited	Small Caps	AM/PM, BC/AD, abbreviations
Superscript	Garamond Premier Pro	~70%	Superscript	Footnote refs, ordinals

Table 3: Character Styles Reference

2.5 Object Styles Setup

Object styles control the appearance of placed images and other objects.

Style Name	Attributes	Usage
Image Placement	Centered, 85% column width, 12pt text wrap	All chapter illustrations
Decorative Ornament	Centered, no text wrap, 30% column width	Section dividers, flourishes
Full-Page Image	Full column width, 18pt text wrap	Full-page illustrations

Table 4: Object Styles Reference

Section III: Importing the Manuscript

With your InDesign document properly set up, you are ready to import the prepared manuscript. This section covers the import process and essential post-import cleanup.

3.1 Import Process

- ☐ File → Place (Ctrl/Cmd+D)
- ☐ Select the prepared .DOCX file
- ☐ BEFORE clicking, check "Show Import Options"
- ☐ In Import Options:
 - ☐ ☐ Table of Contents: Generate (if available)
 - ☐ ☐ Index: Do not generate
 - ☐ ☐ Footnotes: Preserve
 - ☐ ☐ Endnotes: Preserve
 - ☐ ☐ Use Typographer's Quotes: YES
 - ☐ ☐ Remove Text and Table Formatting: YES (apply InDesign styles)
- ☐ Click OK
- ☐ Shift+Click on first page to autoflow text
- ☐ Let InDesign create all necessary pages automatically

 **Tip:** If InDesign warns about missing fonts during import, make note of which fonts are missing and resolve them after import completes.

3.2 Post-Import Cleanup

After importing, verify the text flow and formatting throughout the entire document.

- ☐ Verify all chapters imported in correct order
- ☐ Check that Part dividers landed on recto (right) pages
- ☐ Verify chapter openers begin on recto pages
- ☐ Check for any overset text (red + symbol in text thread)
- ☐ Review first and last page of each chapter
- ☐ Ensure no widows/orphans at page breaks
- ☐ Apply correct paragraph styles to any unstyled text
- ☐ Check that italic and bold formatting survived import
- ☐ Verify special characters (em-dashes, ellipsis) are correct

 **Warning:** Overset text (indicated by a red + symbol on the text frame) means content is being cut off. Thread the text to a new frame immediately.

AI Prompts — Import & Cleanup

 AI PROMPT

"Import this Word document into the current InDesign layout, preserving all text formatting and automatically mapping heading styles to existing paragraph styles. Flow text across all pages."

 AI PROMPT

"Check this imported manuscript for any formatting inconsistencies, missing styles, or text flow issues. List all problems found page by page."

 AI PROMPT

"Automatically detect and mark chapter boundaries in this imported text, applying chapter title styles and inserting page breaks at each new chapter."

Section IV: Image Placement

This section covers the placement of chapter illustrations throughout the book. Proper image placement enhances the reading experience and maintains visual consistency.

4.1 Image Insertion Checklist

- ☐ Identify all [IMAGE] placeholder markers in text
- ☐ Delete placeholder text
- ☐ Use File → Place to insert actual images
- ☐ Apply Object Style "Image Placement"
- ☐ Set text wrap to "Wrap Around Bounding Box" with 12pt offset
- ☐ Center images between margins
- ☐ Add figure caption below each image
- ☐ Link captions to images (Group them)
- ☐ Ensure images are anchored to relevant paragraphs
- ☐ Check image resolution: View → Display Performance → High Quality
- ☐ Verify no images cross spread gutter awkwardly
- ☐ Ensure images don't fall at page bottoms (keep with next paragraph)

4.2 Image Specifications Table

Use this table to track the placement and specifications of each illustration. Fill in as images are placed.

Chapter	Image File	Print Width	Print Height	Placement	Caption
Ch 1	ch01_electricity.jpg	4.0"	2.5"	p. 3, after para 2	TBD
Ch 2	ch02_resonance.jpg	4.0"	2.5"	TBD	TBD
Ch 3	ch03_intelligence.jpg	4.0"	2.5"	TBD	TBD
Ch 4	ch04_goddess.jpg	4.0"	2.5"	TBD	TBD
...	...	...	...	...	...

Table 5: Image Placement Specifications (fill in during placement)

Image Placement Guidelines

- Place images on recto (right) pages when possible for visual impact.
- Avoid placing images on the first page of a chapter (keep focus on the opening text).
- Ensure at least 2-3 paragraphs of text separate consecutive images.
- Images should relate directly to the adjacent text content.

- Maintain consistent sizing: all images at 85% of column width unless artistic reason dictates otherwise.

 **Warning:** Never stretch or distort images to fit. Always maintain the original aspect ratio. Crop if necessary to achieve consistent sizing.

AI Prompts — Image Placement

AI PROMPT

"Find all image placeholders in this document and suggest optimal placement for each based on surrounding text content and page layout."

AI PROMPT

"Adjust all placed images to have consistent sizing at 85% of text column width with 12pt text wrap offset and centered alignment."

AI PROMPT

"Check all images for minimum 300 DPI resolution at their current print size and flag any that need replacement with higher resolution versions."

Section V: Typography Refinement

After all content and images are placed, refine the typography for a polished, professional appearance. This section addresses fine-tuning text settings and special typographic elements.

5.1 Fine-Tuning Text

- ☐ Enable Optical Margin Alignment (Story panel)
- ☐ Adjust hyphenation settings (min 5 letters, 2 before/after break)
- ☐ Apply No Break to proper names (select name, Type → No Break)
- ☐ Fix any rivers in justified text (if using justification)
- ☐ Check for ladders (3+ consecutive lines ending with hyphen)
- ☐ Eliminate widows (single word on last line of paragraph)
- ☐ Eliminate orphans (single line of paragraph at top of page)
- ☐ Fine-tune letter spacing in justified text (+- 3% max)
- ☐ Review every spread for visual balance
- ☐ Ensure consistent rag in left-aligned text

Widow & Orphan Control

Widows and orphans break the reading flow and look unprofessional. InDesign can control these automatically, but manual review is still essential.

- A widow is a single word or very short line at the end of a paragraph.
- An orphan is the first line of a paragraph that appears alone at the bottom of a page.
- A lone line at the top of a page from the previous paragraph is also an orphan.

 **Tip:** For stubborn widows, try adjusting the word spacing (+- 3%) or slightly condensing the text width. As a last resort, rewrite the sentence.

5.2 Special Typography Elements

Drop Caps

Each chapter opener should feature a three-line drop cap on the first letter of the first paragraph. This creates a beautiful literary entrance point for each chapter.

- ☐ Apply drop cap to first paragraph of each chapter (12 chapters)
- ☐ Set drop cap to 3 lines tall
- ☐ Use Cormorant Garamond for the drop cap character
- ☐ Ensure adequate spacing between drop cap and text (minimum 6pt)

- ☐ Verify drop cap aligns properly with text baseline
- ☐ Check that descenders don't collide with the drop cap

Chapter Title Ornaments

A subtle decorative element below each chapter title adds visual elegance.

- ☐ Add decorative rule below chapter titles (0.5pt, warm brown)
- ☐ Set rule width to approximately 40% of text column
- ☐ Center rule under chapter title
- ☐ Add 24pt space between rule and first paragraph
- ☐ Use consistent ornament across all chapters

Part Divider Pages

Part dividers serve as major structural breaks in the narrative. They should feel significant and dramatic.

- ☐ Apply C-Master to part divider pages
- ☐ Part number above part title ("Part I")
- ☐ Part name centered on page (Cormorant Garamond Light 36pt)
- ☐ Vertically centered in page area
- ☐ Add subtle decorative element if desired
- ☐ Next page should begin with chapter title on B-Master

AI Prompts — Typography Refinement

AI PROMPT

"Apply 3-line drop caps in Cormorant Garamond to the first paragraph of each chapter in this document."

AI PROMPT

"Review the entire document for typographic issues: widows, orphans, rivers, improper hyphenation, and inconsistent spacing. Provide a list of all issues found with page numbers."

AI PROMPT

"Optimize the text flow by adjusting paragraph spacing and tracking to eliminate all widows and orphans while maintaining consistent page density."

Section VI: Front & Back Matter

Front matter and back matter frame the main content of the book. These pages require special styling and careful attention to publishing conventions.

6.1 Front Matter Setup

Half-Title Page

- ☐ Create half-title page (recto, right side)
- ☐ Show only book title: "WE ARE WOLF"
- ☐ Use Cormorant Garamond, 18pt, centered
- ☐ Apply D-Master (no headers/footers)

Title Page

- ☐ Full title: "WE ARE WOLF" (Cormorant Garamond, 24pt, centered)
- ☐ Author name: "Kennedy Singh" (Garamond Premier Pro, 16pt, centered)
- ☐ Publisher: "Mangu Publishing House" (10pt, centered, bottom third)
- ☐ Apply D-Master

Copyright Page

The copyright page contains essential legal and bibliographic information.

- ☐ Copyright notice: © 2025 Kennedy Singh. All rights reserved.
- ☐ ISBN: 979-8-2187-4644-5
- ☐ Publisher address and contact information
- ☐ Edition information (First Edition)
- ☐ Library of Congress information (if applicable)
- ☐ Credits for cover design, illustrations, typography
- ☐ Printed in [Country]
- ☐ Apply D-Master, left-aligned text

Dedication Page

- ☐ Dedication text (Cormorant Garamond Light Italic, 12pt)
- ☐ Centered both horizontally and vertically
- ☐ 20pt leading for elegant spacing

- ☐ Apply D-Master

Table of Contents

- ☐ Generate auto-TOC from paragraph styles
- ☐ Include all chapter titles with page numbers
- ☐ Use dot leaders between title and page number
- ☐ Format in Garamond Premier Pro, 11pt
- ☐ Verify page numbers are correct after final pagination

6.2 Back Matter Setup

Epilogue

- ☐ Style epilogue as a chapter (B-Master, chapter title style)
- ☐ Label as "Epilogue" rather than chapter number
- ☐ Apply body text style with proper formatting

Acknowledgments

- ☐ Heading: "Acknowledgments" (chapter title style)
- ☐ Body text for acknowledgments content
- ☐ May use slightly more informal formatting if desired

About the Author

- ☐ Heading: "About the Author" (chapter title style)
- ☐ Author photo placeholder (if applicable)
- ☐ Bio text in body style
- ☐ Optional: author website or social media

AI Prompts — Front & Back Matter

AI PROMPT

"Generate a copyright page layout with standard publishing legal text for a 2025 literary fiction novel published by Mangu Publishing House with ISBN 979-8-2187-4644-5."



AI PROMPT

"Create an automatically updating Table of Contents based on chapter title paragraph styles, formatted with dot leaders and page numbers."



AI PROMPT

"Design a professional About the Author page layout with placeholder for author photo and bio text area."

Section VII: Color, Paper & Print Considerations

This section addresses color management, paper selection, and print production specifications to ensure the final book matches your creative vision.

7.1 Color Setup

- ☐ Document color mode: CMYK
- ☐ Assign color swatches:
 - ☐ Body Text: Black (C0 M0 Y0 K100)
 - ☐ Chapter Title: Dark Brown (C0 M25 Y45 K65)
 - ☐ Accent/Rule: Warm Brown (C0 M20 Y35 K45)
 - ☐ Running Header: Medium Gray (C0 M0 Y0 K55)
- ☐ Create a "Text" swatch category
- ☐ Create an "Accent" swatch category
- ☐ Ensure all colors are process (not spot) for cost efficiency

Swatch Reference Table

Swatch Name	C	M	Y	K	Usage
Text Black	0	0	0	100	Body text, captions
Dark Brown	0	25	45	65	Chapter titles
Warm Brown	0	20	35	45	Rules, accents
Medium Gray	0	0	0	55	Running headers
Light Cream	0	3	8	4	Background tint if needed

Table 6: CMYK Color Swatch Specifications

7.2 Paper Recommendations

Paper choice significantly affects the reading experience and production cost. Consider these options:

Option	Paper Type	Weight	Finish	Cost	Best For
Premium	Mohawk Superfine Eggshell	80 lb text	Eggshell	\$\$\$\$	High-end literary editions
Standard	Cougar Natural	60 lb text	Smooth	\$\$	Trade paperback (recommended)
Economy	50# White Offset	50 lb text	Smooth	\$	Mass market edition

Table 7: Paper Selection Guide

 **Tip:** For literary fiction, we recommend the Standard option (Cougar Natural 60 lb) as it provides excellent readability and a quality feel at a reasonable cost.

Additional Print Specifications

- Binding: Perfect bound (standard for paperbacks)
- Cover finish: Matte lamination recommended for literary fiction
- Spine width: Calculate based on page count and paper thickness
- Cover stock: 10pt C1S (coated one side) minimum

Section VIII: Export & Print-Ready Checklist

The final phase of production involves thorough review, PDF export with correct settings, and packaging files for the printer. Follow every step in this section carefully.

8.1 Pre-Export Review

- ☐ Spell check entire document (Edit → Spelling → Check Spelling)
- ☐ Preflight: Window → Output → Preflight
- ☐ Resolve ALL preflight errors (zero errors required)
- ☐ Check for missing fonts (Type → Find Font)
- ☐ Check for missing/modified links (Window → Links)
- ☐ Verify all images are CMYK or Grayscale
- ☐ Review color separations if applicable
- ☐ Check registration marks are enabled for print
- ☐ Verify bleed settings are correct
- ☐ Export a test PDF and review thoroughly
- ☐ Have another person review the PDF
- ☐ Compare final page count to printer requirements (multiples of 4)

 **Warning:** The page count MUST be divisible by 4. If not, add blank pages at the end as needed. Most printers require signatures in multiples of 4, 8, 16, or 32 pages.

8.2 PDF Export Settings

For PRINT Export

- ☐ File → Adobe PDF Presets → [PDF/X-4 for print]
- ☐ Standard: PDF/X-4 (or PDF/X-1a if printer requires)
- ☐ Compression:
 - ☐ Downsampling to 300 DPI for images above 450 DPI
 - ☐ Compression: ZIP (lossless) for line art
 - ☐ Compression: JPEG Maximum for photographs
- ☐ Marks and Bleeds:
 - ☐ Crop Marks: YES
 - ☐ Bleed Marks: YES
 - ☐ Use Document Bleed Settings: YES
 - ☐ Registration Marks: YES
 - ☐ Color Bars: Optional (printer may add)
- ☐ Output:

- ☐ ☐ Convert to Destination (Preserve Numbers)
- ☐ ☐ Color Destination: Document CMYK
- ☐ ☐ Include ICC Profile if required by printer
- ☐ General:
 - ☐ ☐ Pages: All
 - ☐ ☐ Spreads: NO (export as single pages)
 - ☐ ☐ Optimize for Fast Web Preview: NO

For EBOOK/REVIEW Export

- ☐ File → Adobe PDF Presets → [Smallest File Size]
- ☐ Standard: Smallest File Size
- ☐ Compression: Medium quality JPEG
- ☐ No marks or bleeds
- ☐ RGB color space
- ☐ Include bookmarks and hyperlinks if applicable

File Naming Convention

Save both versions with clear, versioned naming:

- Print: WeAreWolf_PRINT_v1.pdf
- Review: WeAreWolf_REVIEW_v1.pdf
- Increment version number with each revision (v1, v2, v3...)

8.3 Printer File Package

- ☐ File → Package
- ☐ Include: Fonts, Links, ICC Profiles
- ☐ Create report: YES
- ☐ Package location: Named folder (WeAreWolf_Package_v1)
- ☐ Verify package contents:
 - ☐ ☐ .INDD file
 - ☐ ☐ PDF export (print-ready)
 - ☐ ☐ All linked images in Links folder
 - ☐ ☐ All fonts in Document Fonts folder
 - ☐ ☐ .TXT report file
- ☐ Zip entire package folder
- ☐ Upload to printer's FTP/portal OR email if small enough

Printer Instruction Sheet

Include a text file or email with the following information:

- Trim size: 5.5" x 8.5"
- Page count: [final count]
- Paper specification: 60 lb smooth text (or chosen option)
- Binding type: Perfect bound
- Cover finish: Matte lamination
- Quantity ordered: [number]
- Delivery address: [full address]
- Contact: Kennedy Singh / Mangu Publishing House

AI Prompts — Export & Packaging



AI PROMPT

"Preflight this InDesign document and list all errors, warnings, and missing elements that need to be resolved before print export."



AI PROMPT

"Export this document as a PDF/X-4 compliant print-ready file with crop marks, bleed marks, and proper color conversion settings."



AI PROMPT

"Package this InDesign document with all fonts, linked images, and create a package report for the print vendor."

Section IX: Quality Assurance Checklist

This master checklist combines all critical items from previous sections. Complete this as a final verification before declaring the book print-ready. Go through each item methodically.

Final Verification Checklist

- ☐ Cover matches title page exactly (spelling, punctuation, capitalization)
- ☐ Copyright year is correct (2025)
- ☐ ISBN matches everywhere it appears (979-8-2187-4644-5)
- ☐ Author name consistent throughout (Kennedy Singh)
- ☐ Page numbers sequential with no gaps
- ☐ Table of Contents matches actual page numbers
- ☐ No placeholder text remains anywhere in document
- ☐ All images have captions
- ☐ All captions have correct numbering/identification
- ☐ Front matter page numbering (Roman numerals) correct: i, ii, iii...
- ☐ Body page numbering (Arabic numerals) starts at Chapter 1
- ☐ Running headers reflect correct chapter names on recto pages
- ☐ Running header shows book title on verso pages
- ☐ No blank pages except intentional blanks
- ☐ Facing pages don't have awkward breaks (widows/orphans at spread)
- ☐ Print PDF opens without errors in Acrobat Reader
- ☐ Print PDF page count is divisible by 4
- ☐ All fonts are properly embedded in PDF
- ☐ All images display at full resolution in PDF
- ☐ Bleed area contains content extending past trim lines
- ☐ Crop marks visible in print PDF
- ☐ No RGB images in print PDF (all CMYK or Grayscale)
- ☐ Preflight report shows zero errors
- ☐ Package includes all required files (INDD, links, fonts)
- ☐ Spine width calculated and cover file prepared
- ☐ Printer has confirmed file receipt and specifications

 **Warning:** Do NOT skip this checklist. Each item represents a potential production error that could result in costly reprints or delays.

 **Tip:** Print a single physical proof copy before committing to a full print run. Review the physical copy under good lighting for any issues not visible on screen.

Section X: Troubleshooting Guide

When problems arise during production, consult this guide for quick solutions to common issues. Each entry provides the problem symptom, likely cause, and recommended solution.

Common Problems & Solutions

Problem	Cause	Solution
Text overset (+ symbol)	More text than frame capacity	Thread to new frame or resize existing frame
Missing fonts warning	Font not installed on system	Install font or replace with available alternative
Low-res image warning	Image below 300 DPI at print size	Replace with higher resolution file
Color mode mismatch	RGB image in CMYK document	Convert in Photoshop or use different image
Broken links	Moved or renamed image files	Relink via Links panel (Window → Links)
Styles not applying	Wrong style selected or override	Clear overrides and reapply style
Widow/orphan issues	Default Keep settings too strict	Adjust Keep Options in paragraph style
Page number wrong	Section numbering issue	Check Numbering & Section Options
TOC not updating	Manual text not refreshed	Right-click → Update Table of Contents
Export fails	Corrupted element on page	Export by halves to isolate problem page
Print PDF too large	Uncompressed images	Adjust compression in PDF export settings
Text reflows unexpectedly	Font substitution or missing font	Embed all fonts or package document
Images appear pixelated	Display performance set to Fast	View → Display Performance → High Quality
Running header wrong	Text variable not set correctly	Check Text Variables definition
InDesign crashes on open	Corrupted preference file	Hold Ctrl+Alt+Shift while launching to reset prefs

Table 8: Troubleshooting Quick Reference

Emergency Recovery

If InDesign crashes or becomes unresponsive:

1. Don't panic. InDesign auto-saves recovery data.
2. Restart InDesign and look for recovery dialog.
3. If recovery fails, check the InDesign Recovery folder.
4. Save recovered file with a new version number immediately.
5. Review the recovered file against your last manual save.

 **Warning:** Save your work frequently (Ctrl+S) and maintain versioned backups. Use File → Save As with version numbers: WeAreWolf_v01.indd, WeAreWolf_v02.indd, etc.

Section XI: AI Prompt Library Quick Reference

This consolidated reference contains all AI prompts from this guide, organized by workflow phase. Copy and paste directly into your AI interface as needed.

Phase 1: Document Setup

When to use: Before importing any content, during initial document creation.

Prompt: *Create a new InDesign document for a 5.5x8.5 inch literary fiction book with facing pages, 0.75 inch margins, and a warm, earthy color theme for the workspace.*

Expected result: A properly configured InDesign document ready for manuscript import.

Verify: Check page size, margins, and facing pages settings match specifications.

When to use: After creating the document, before setting up paragraph styles.

Prompt: *Set up master pages for a book with alternating left/right page layouts, including running headers with book title and chapter name, and centered page numbers in the footer.*

Expected result: A-Master and B-Master configured with proper running headers and footers.

Verify: Preview each master page and confirm header/footer elements are correctly positioned.

When to use: After master pages are set up, before importing text.

Prompt: *Configure paragraph styles for a literary novel including body text, chapter titles, part dividers, first paragraph with drop cap, and block quotes.*

Expected result: Complete set of paragraph styles ready for manuscript formatting.

Verify: Test each style by applying it to sample text and reviewing the result.

Phase 2: Style Creation

When to use: When defining the primary body text style.

Prompt: *Create a paragraph style for literary fiction body text using Garamond font, 11pt size, 14.5pt leading, with a 1.5em first-line indent and no space between paragraphs. Apply optical margin alignment.*

Expected result: Body Text style with proper Garamond formatting and optical alignment.

Verify: Apply style to a sample paragraph and check font, size, leading, and indent.

When to use: When creating chapter title styling.

Prompt: *Set up a chapter title style with Cormorant Garamond, 28pt, centered, with a page break before, and add a rule below with 0.5pt weight in warm brown color.*

Expected result: Chapter title style that forces page breaks and includes decorative rule.

Verify: Test by applying to sample chapter title text.

When to use: When setting up drop caps for chapter openers.

Prompt: *Create a drop cap style that applies a 3-line drop cap in Cormorant Garamond to the first letter of the first paragraph after each chapter heading.*

Expected result: Drop cap formatting on first paragraphs with 3-line tall initial character.

Verify: Check each chapter's first paragraph for proper drop cap appearance.

When to use: When configuring automatic master page switching.

Prompt: *Configure automatic chapter openers that suppress the running header on the first page of each chapter and use a different master page layout.*

Expected result: Chapters automatically use B-Master for first page, A-Master for subsequent pages.

Verify: Scroll through document and confirm master page assignments are correct.

Phase 3: Import & Cleanup

When to use: When importing the manuscript DOCX file.

Prompt: *Import this Word document into the current InDesign layout, preserving all text formatting and automatically mapping heading styles to existing paragraph styles. Flow text across all pages.*

Expected result: Manuscript imported with styles applied and text flowing through all pages.

Verify: Check chapter order, style application, and text flow for completeness.

When to use: After import, to verify formatting integrity.

Prompt: *Check this imported manuscript for any formatting inconsistencies, missing styles, or text flow issues. List all problems found page by page.*

Expected result: Comprehensive list of any formatting or flow issues requiring attention.

Verify: Review each reported issue and fix manually as needed.

When to use: To automatically identify and format chapter boundaries.

Prompt: *Automatically detect and mark chapter boundaries in this imported text, applying chapter title styles and inserting page breaks at each new chapter.*

Expected result: All 12 chapters properly formatted with correct styles and page breaks.

Verify: Review each chapter opening for correct style and master page application.

Phase 4: Image Placement

When to use: When placing chapter illustrations.

Prompt: *Find all image placeholders in this document and suggest optimal placement for each based on surrounding text content and page layout.*

Expected result: Recommended placement locations for each image with reasoning.

Verify: Evaluate each recommendation against design principles before placing.

When to use: After images are placed, to standardize sizing.

Prompt: *Adjust all placed images to have consistent sizing at 85% of text column width with 12pt text wrap offset and centered alignment.*

Expected result: All images uniformly sized and positioned throughout document.

Verify: Visually inspect each image for consistent sizing and alignment.

When to use: Before final export, to verify image quality.

Prompt: *Check all images for minimum 300 DPI resolution at their current print size and flag any that need replacement with higher resolution versions.*

Expected result: List of images meeting or failing the 300 DPI requirement with specific values.

Verify: Replace any flagged images with higher resolution versions before export.

Phase 5: Typography Refinement

When to use: After all content is placed, for typographic polish.

Prompt: *Apply 3-line drop caps in Cormorant Garamond to the first paragraph of each chapter in this document.*

Expected result: All 12 chapter-opening paragraphs have 3-line drop caps.

Verify: Check each chapter for proper drop cap rendering and spacing.

When to use: Final review pass for typographic issues.

Prompt: *Review the entire document for typographic issues: widows, orphans, rivers, improper hyphenation, and inconsistent spacing. Provide a list of all issues found with page numbers.*

Expected result: Detailed list of typographic issues with page references.

Verify: Address each issue manually; not all can be auto-fixed.

When to use: When optimizing page breaks and text flow.

Prompt: *Optimize the text flow by adjusting paragraph spacing and tracking to eliminate all widows and orphans while maintaining consistent page density.*

Expected result: Reduced widow/orphan instances with balanced page layouts.

Verify: Review each adjusted spread for visual balance and readability.

Phase 6: Front & Back Matter

When to use: When creating the copyright page.

Prompt: *Generate a copyright page layout with standard publishing legal text for a 2025 literary fiction novel published by Mangu Publishing House with ISBN 979-8-2187-4644-5.*

Expected result: Properly formatted copyright page with all legal elements.

Verify: Confirm ISBN, copyright year, and publisher details are accurate.

When to use: When generating the Table of Contents.

Prompt: *Create an automatically updating Table of Contents based on chapter title paragraph styles, formatted with dot leaders and page numbers.*

Expected result: Auto-updating TOC that reflects current pagination.

Verify: Update TOC and check page numbers match actual chapter starts.

When to use: When designing the About the Author page.

Prompt: *Design a professional About the Author page layout with placeholder for author photo and bio text area.*

Expected result: Professional author page with photo placeholder and bio area.

Verify: Confirm photo dimensions work with provided author image.

Phase 7: Export & Packaging

When to use: Before exporting the print-ready PDF.

Prompt: *Preflight this InDesign document and list all errors, warnings, and missing elements that need to be resolved before print export.*

Expected result: Comprehensive preflight report with all issues categorized.

Verify: Resolve every error before proceeding to export.

When to use: When creating the final print PDF.

Prompt: *Export this document as a PDF/X-4 compliant print-ready file with crop marks, bleed marks, and proper color conversion settings.*

Expected result: PDF/X-4 compliant file ready for commercial printing.

Verify: Open PDF in Acrobat and confirm all marks, bleeds, and color settings.

When to use: Final step before sending to printer.

Prompt: *Package this InDesign document with all fonts, linked images, and create a package report for the print vendor.*

Expected result: Complete package folder with INDD, links, fonts, and report.

Verify: Open package folder and confirm all files are present and accounted for.

Document History

Track changes to this guide for version control and reference.

Version	Date	Changes	Author
1.0	June 2025	Initial production guide creation	Production Team

Table 9: Document Revision History

About This Guide

This production guide was prepared specifically for the publication of "We Are Wolf" by Kennedy Singh (ISBN: 979-8-2187-4644-5), published by Mangu Publishing House in 2025.

The guide covers the complete workflow from manuscript preparation through print-ready export, with integrated AI prompts to accelerate production while maintaining professional quality standards.

For questions or updates to this guide, contact the production team at Mangu Publishing House.

